

522 N Claremont Ave

West Town · Chicago, IL 60612 · RT-4 · 2,967 SF lot · Built 1879 · Opportunity Zone

OUR TAKE

Real as-of-right upside, tangled by unresolved tax and title basics.

A small RT-4 lot running well under its FAR ceiling, with a plausible as-of-right path to a two- or three-unit conversion and no zoning relief required. But delinquent taxes with a 2025 figure that breaks from the trend, plus a deed record showing no arm's-length sale, mean you're underwriting on incomplete information. Confirm the tax balance and ownership chain before sizing any plan.

OWNERSHIP RECORD Kalsi Sukhmit No arm's-length sale recorded	ZONING RT-4 Two-flat / multi-unit, up to 3 units	PROPERTY TAXES \$16,262.60 2024 full year · delinquent · 2025 figure unverified	TITLE / LIEN STATUS Delinquent Taxes No lis pendens / foreclosure found	FAR CAPACITY 0.55 / 1.2 1,922 sf unused of max	OPPORTUNITY ZONE Yes Federal OZ-eligible tract
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WHAT THE PUBLIC RECORD SAYS ABOUT THIS ASSET

Independent of what you plan to do with it

■ Taxes are delinquent, and the 2025 figure breaks from the trend.

Confirmed: payment status is **delinquent**. Tax history: 2023 – \$11,451.94, 2024 – \$16,262.60, 2025 – \$8,944.47 (\$745/month). The steep drop in 2025, paired with delinquency, suggests that figure may reflect a partial or unresolved billing cycle rather than a real decline in burden. Confirm the current balance directly with the Cook County Treasurer before underwriting carrying cost — unresolved delinquency creates lien exposure.

✓ The building uses less than half its zoning envelope.

Confirmed: RT-4 allows a max FAR of 1.2 (3,560 sf buildable) on this 2,967 sf lot. The existing 1,638 sf building sits at a 0.55 FAR, leaving 1,922 sf of unused capacity. This points to real as-of-right room to expand or add units without a zoning change. Confirm the buildable envelope against the 38 ft / 3-story height cap and setbacks before sizing anything.

■ A three-unit conversion looks as-of-right — if this lot counts as "standard."

Confirmed: RT-4 permits multi-unit apartments up to 3 units per standard lot, plus two-flats and townhouses, with no special use permit required; funnel data confirms no zoning relief is needed for the current plan. This suggests the cleanest execution path is a by-right two- or three-unit conversion. Not yet confirmed: whether this specific 2,967 sf lot meets the "standard lot" threshold for the 3-unit allowance — verify with the zoning administrator before locking in unit count.

■ Adding units means adding parking, on a lot with little room to spare.

Confirmed: RT-4 requires 1 parking space per unit; the lot totals 2,967 sf, currently holding a 1,638 sf structure. Fitting two or three on-site spaces alongside any FAR-driven addition will narrow how much of the 1,922 sf remaining capacity is actually usable. Run a site-plan test of parking layout before finalizing unit count or addition size.

■ **There's no arm's-length sale in the record — get comfortable with why.**

Confirmed: Recorder of Deeds data lists the same name, Kalsi Sukhmit, as both prior owner (grantor) and current owner (grantee), with no sale price or transaction date supplied. This suggests either a long-held property with no recent captured transfer, or a non-arm's-length conveyance rather than a market sale. Confirm actual chain of title with a title company before relying on any assumed basis.

✓ **Transit access is genuinely strong for a small residential lot.**

Confirmed: Metra Western Ave station is 0.19 mi away (TOD-eligible), with CTA bus routes 65, 49, and X49 all within 0.07 mi. This level of walkable transit is a real demand driver for renters, even though the nearest CTA Green Line stop (Damen, 0.62 mi) is farther out. Supports the case for adding rental units rather than holding as a single-family property.

■ **Daycare is a permitted as-of-right use, and the area is underserved for it.**

Confirmed: Day Care Center is permitted in RT-4 without special approval. West Town shows 2.37 children per licensed childcare slot versus 1.26 in the broader ZIP — an underserved ratio. This points to a plausible as-of-right alternative to residential conversion, though it would require separately evaluating the building's suitability for that use. Secondary consideration, not the primary path.